Table 1.1 Branches of Physics

Classical Physics		**Refers to traditional physics that was recognized and developed before the beginning of the 20th century**
	Branch	**Major focus**
1.	Classical mechanics	The study of forces acting on bodies whether at rest or in motion
2.	Thermodynamics	The study of the relationship between heat and other forms of energy
3.	Optics	The study of light
4.	Electricity and magnetism	The study of electricity and magnetism and their mutual relationship
5.	Acoustics	The study of the production and propagation of sound waves
6.	Astrophysics	The branch of physics which deals with the study of the physics of astronomical bodies
7.	Relativity	One of the branches of theoretical physics which deals with the relationship between space, time and energy particularly with respect to objects moving in different ways .
Modern Physics		**Refers to the concepts in physics that have surfaced since the beginning of the 20th century.**
1.	*Quantum mechanics	The study of the discrete nature of phenomena at the atomic and subatomic levels
2.	Atomic physics	The branch of physics which deals with the structure and properties of the atom
3.	Nuclear physics	The branch of physics which deals with the structure, properties and reaction of the nuclei of atoms.
4.	Condensed matter physics	The study of the properties of condensed materials (solids, liquids and those intermediate between them and dense gas). It branches into various sub-divisions including developing fields such as nano science, photonics etc. It covers the basics of materials science, which aims at developing new material with better properties for promising applications.
5.	High energy physics	The study of the nature of the particles.

*Quantum mechanics is a broader approach; classical results can be reproduced in quantum mechanics also. Detailed explanation is beyond the scope of this book.

3 and 4). The basics of gravitation and its consequences are discussed in unit 6. Older branches of physics such as different properties of matter are discussed in unit 7. The impact of heat and investigations of its consequences are covered in units 8 and 9. Important features of oscillations and wave motion are covered in units 10 and 11.

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